

Mayer's Principles of MULTIMEDIA DESIGN Checklist

Designing for Clarity

PRE-TRAINING *frontload key concepts*

- ☐ What might confuse someone seeing this for the **first time**?
- ☐ Would a quick **orientation** to key concepts make this easier?

SIGNALING *guide attention with cues*

- ☐ What signals **show** me what's **important** here?
- ☐ Where does my attention **naturally drift** to?

SEGMENTING *break into chunks*

- ☐ Is the information delivered in **bite-size pieces** or all at once?
- ☐ Can I **control the pace** of content before moving on to the next topic?

ALIGNMENT *keep related concepts close together*

- ☐ Do I have to **"eye-jump"** across the screen to connect topics?
- ☐ Do the visuals **appear** right when the narration/text refers to them?

Designing for Balance

COHERENCE *remove clutter & seductive details*

- ☐ If I strip away one element, would the **core idea** still hold?
- ☐ Does anything **compete** with the main message for my attention?

MULTIMEDIA *text + pictures > text alone*

- ☐ Would this concept make sense if it were **just** text?
- ☐ Where can a picture help **reduce** the amount of text?

MODALITY *spoken words + visuals > text + visuals*

- ☐ Is text **competing** with visuals?
- ☐ Would hearing narration **free up** my visual channel?

REDUNDANCY *don't overload channels*

- ☐ Am I hearing **and** reading the **same** full sentences at once?
- ☐ Can **bullet points** summarize text instead?

Designing for Connection

PERZONALIZATION *conversational style beats formal*

- ☐ Do these words sound like something I'd say **out loud**?
- ☐ Would simpler, more human phrasing **reduce mental effort**?

VOICE *human-sounding voice > robotic*

- ☐ Does the narrator sound **human** or is it distracting?
- ☐ Does the narrator's tone sound like someone **reading text** aloud?

IMAGE *gestures, gaze, expression support learning*

- ☐ Is the avatar on screen **adding value** to the explanation, or just sitting there?
- ☐ Does the avatar look and move in a way that feels **uncanny**?

EMBODIMENT *guide attention with social cues*

- ☐ Do the speaker's **movements** help highlight what matters?
- ☐ Does it feel like I'm just watching a **digital puppet**?